(G___.0) ANDROMEDAN SINGULARITY GENERATOR

While the origin of this rarely-seen system is unclear, Galactic scientists have hypothesized it is a permutation of the Displacement Device (G18.0) technology (however, no other empire fully understands the Generator's underlying principles, nor may a captured Generator be operated or copied). A Singularity Generator creates a dramatic, highly-focused, and very short-lived distortion in local space-time; the effects are not unlike those of a gravitational singularity, also called a "Black Hole" (P4.0), and have been described as "plucking the fabric of space-time like a guitar string". Similar to the Displacement Device (G18.8), the distortion effect places a limit on the number of Generators that may safely operate in a given volume of space (G___.5).

The first recorded instance of a Singularity Generator was found, *circa* Y183, in fragmentary sensor readings from the log buoy of a hapless Romulan War Eagle, long relegated to internal security tasks, which blundered across a Dominator (or so the Romulans claimed) in a backwater of the Empire. Because many lone ships that encountered Andromedan forces didn't survive, it's unclear just how many Singularity Generators the Andromedans may have had, when they were actually first deployed, or how difficult it was for them to field a Singularity Generator. The Desecrator Starbase (R10.7) did not employ one during Operation Unity (U6.0), but it's unknown if that was because it didn't have a Generator, or if Andromedan tactical doctrine didn't call for its use.

The Generator was thought to be a primarily defensive system, used to break up an enemy formation or disrupt tactics like drone waves; nevertheless, careful deployment may allow it to be used offensively.

(G ___.1) DESIGNATION

(G___.11) INSTALLATION: No Andromedan unit was specifically designed to carry a Singularity Generator. Instead, a Generator replaced a Displacement Device (DisDev) on a ship or Base. Only a Size Class 3 or larger unit may carry a Generator, even though some Size Class 4 units, such as the Python (R10.9), have DisDevs; only a Size Class 2 ship, or a Base, could mount more than one; only a Base could mount more than two. However, if an Andromedan unit only has one DisDev, then, regardless of Size Class, it cannot replace that with a Generator. No ship may replace more than one-half (round down) of its DisDevs with Generators.

(G___.111) A Base Station (R10.29), Battle Station (R10.30), Conqueror (R10.60), Conquistador (R10.8), Destructor (R10.63), Exploiter (R10.38), Infestor (R10.14), Instigator (R10.41), Imposer (R10.27), Intruder (R10.3), Missionary (R10.37), Ravager (R10.42) and a Shiva (R10.64) could each mount a single Generator (replacing a DisDev).

(G___.112) A Demolisher (R10.47), Demon (R10.46), Devastator (R10.26), Dictator (R10.44), Dominator (R10.2), Dominatrix (R10.40), and a Dominion (R10.45) each could mount up to two Generators, each replacing a DisDev.

(G___.113) The Desecrator Starbase (R10.7) could have up to three Generators, and still have at least three DisDevs.

(G___.12) SSD: Each DisDev box that has been replaced with a Generator represents one Singularity Generator. If a unit has replaced more than one DisDev with a Generator, then each Generator operates separately.

(G___.121) There is no BPV difference when a DisDev is replaced with a Generator. The change of a ship's configuration is not detectable by Tactical Intelligence (D17.0).

(G___.122) Replacing a DisDev with a Generator (or *vice-versa*) cannot occur in the course of a scenario. The conversion process takes several weeks and requires the services of a base (*e.g.,* a non-base unit could not perform the conversion on its own).

(G___.13) DESTRUCTION,REPAIR: Singularity Generators are destroyed on Flag Bridge hits. They have the same damage priority and Cost of Repair as a DisDev.

(G___.14) FIRE CONTROL: Singularity Generators require Active Fire Control (D6.6) and a lock-on to the target hex (G___.34); Low-Power Fire Control (D6.7), Disrupted Fire Control (D6.68) and Passive Fire Control (D19.0) cannot be used to fire a Singularity Generator, but those Fire Control states do not prevent a unit from arming a Generator.

(G___.15) AVAILABILITY: In a campaign setting, or for the purposes of modifying existing scenarios, Y180 is the earliest an Andromedan ship could have a Singularity Generator.

(G___.151) It would be unlikely (although not impossible) to encounter more than one Generator-equipped ship at a time, even in a large Andromedan force; however, the chance of encountering more than two Generator-equipped ships at the same time should be considered so remote that it would never happen outside of a published scenario.

(G___.152) The Andromedan Krait (R10.23) may not use a Singularity Generator in a Tournament.

(G ___.2) ENERGY REQUIREMENTS

(G___.21) ARMING: Each Generator requires three points of warp power (from warp engines or warp reactors) on each of three consecutive turns.

(G___.211) Warp power allocated using Reserve Warp (H7.4) or Contingent Reserve (H7.6) could begin arming a Generator if it had not been successfully fired (G___.352) that turn.

(G___.212) The Generator may be activated (fired) as early as the first impulse on the last turn of arming.

(G___.213) If a ship has more than one Generator, then it may arm as many as it has, but activation is limited by (G___.31).

(G___.22) HOLDING: An armed Singularity Generator which is not fired on the third turn of arming may not be held.

(G___.221) However, the arming process may be extended in the same

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"rolling delay" manner as a Hellbore (E10.22) by allocating three points of warp power to arming the Generator on the next turn.

(G___.222) If arming energy is not allocated the next turn, then the partial arming energy in the Singularity Generator is lost; since this occurs during Energy Allocation, the power is treated as “released” and must be resolved under (D10.424). Arming must be restarted.

(G___.223) Reserve or non-warp power may not be used to implement the "rolling delay". Allocation of warp power is required.

(G___.23) NO OVERLOAD: There is no overload function for a Singularity Generator.

(G___.24) NO SHOCK: A Singularity Generator never requires a Shock Effect (D23.0) roll.

(G ___.3) OPERATION

(G___.31) RATE LIMITED: Regardless of the number of Singularity Generators a unit has, no unit may operate more than one Generator during a turn, and there must be a delay of at least ¾ of a turn (24 impulses) between firing different Generators mounted on the same unit.

(G___.311) If a multiple-Generator-equipped unit attempts to operate more than one Generator in an impulse, then the unit is immediately drawn into a spatial rift and destroyed (without affecting anything else on the map) and no singularity is formed by the Generators on the destroyed unit. This occurs even if another rule could have prevented one or more of the unit’s Generators from operating successfully (that is, the unit is destroyed simply by attempting to use multiple Generators in an impulse, regardless of if the Generators would have actually worked).

(G___.312) Should a unit attempt to operate another Generator on a subsequent impulse but before the (G___.31) delay expires, then that subsequent firing automatically misses the target hex (G___.352), and further Disrupts the unit’s fire control as if it had been Displaced (G18.53).

(G___.313) When a unit attempts to operate a Generator without the requisite fire control (G___.14), then the Generator automatically misses the target hex (G___.352) but the unit does not otherwise suffer. However, note that (G___.311) supercedes this rule.

(G___.32) EXCLUSIVE WITH DISDEV: A ship is restricted as to when it may operate its DisDev(s) and its Singularity Generator(s), or when it may be displaced (by another DisDev-equipped ship) before or after operating its Singularity Generator, as follows:

(G___.321) If a ship operates a DisDev first, the ship may arm a Singularity Generator, but may not fire it until at least 33 impulses after the DisDev was used; there is an extra impulse delay because the Singularity Generator is fired earlier in Direct-Fire (G___.332) than the DisDev operates. If a Generator is fired in violation of this restriction, it automatically misses the target hex (G___.352).

(G___.322) If a ship operates a Generator first, the ship may arm a DisDev, but may not activate it until at least 32 impulses after the Generator was used (if it does so, the displacement attempt will automatically fail, the target unit will not be displaced, that target unit's Fire Control will not be disrupted, and the energy in the DisDev of the Generator-equipped ship will be lost).

(G___.323) If a ship operates a Generator, then it may not be displaced (by another Andromedan ship) during the same impulse or for the following 16 impulses (the displacement attempt will automatically fail, the ship will not be displaced, its fire control will not be disrupted, the energy in the DisDev of the ship attempting to displace the Generator-equipped ship will be lost).

(G___.324) A ship may not operate a DisDev and a Singularity Generator during the same impulse (the DisDev will automatically fail, the target will not be displaced or have its fire control disrupted, the energy in the DisDev will be lost; the Generator, however, will function normally).

(G___.325) When a Generator-equipped ship is displaced (by another DisDev-equipped Andromedan ship), it may not fire its Singularity Generator until its fire control is no longer Disrupted (G18.53), but there is no additional delay.

(G___.33) DIRECT-FIRE SYSTEM: A Singularity Generator is operated as a direct-fire "weapon" that does not immediately resolve its effects.

(G___.331) The intent to use a Singularity Generator must be announced in the DISDEV DECLARATION STEP of the FIRE ALLOCATION STAGE (6D1) of the impulse in which it is to be used; exception (G___.3311). The ship operating the device, and the target hex, are announced at that time.

(G___.3311) In a campaign setting, or other situation where the forces engaging the Andromedans would find a Singularity Generator to be a novel technology (and consequently be unable to match the sensor readings associated with the Generator to any known device), then when the Generator is employed the Andromedan forces are not required to announce its operation until after it is successfully fired and singularity has formed as a result.

(G___.3312) The announcement (G___.331) is required for any subsequent operation of a Singularity Generator.

(G___.332) The Singularity Generator is operated (fires) during the DIRECT-FIRE WEAPONS FIRE STAGE (6D2) of the DIRECT-FIRE WEAPONS SEGMENT, at the same point as Tractor-Repulsor Beams. The firing is detectable at Tactical intelligence (D17.0) Level A.

(G___.333) A Singularity Generator is not eligible to be controlled by Aegis Fire Control (D13.0). Historically, the Andromedans never had Aegis, but if there were to be some alternate time-line idea or Aegis-like system for Andromedans, then this weapon system is not appropriate for Aegis-like control.

(G___.34) TARGETING: The Singularity Generator is fired at a target hex that is within 25 hexes of the unit firing the Generator, subject to the following restrictions and conditions:

(G___.341) The target hex may not be within an Asteroid Field (P3.0); or,

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within 10 hexes of: an existing singularity (whether that singularity is a natural one or was created by another Singularity Generator); or, a unit with active Positional Stabilizers (G29.0); or, a moon or planet (P2.0). The gravity well of those objects (or the gravity-like effects of Positional Stabilizers) prevents the Generator from functioning. The direct path between the firing ship and the target hex cannot pass through a web hex (except a strength zero web does not interfere), but an ESG has no effect.

(G___.342) The target hex cannot be within a Temporal Elevator (G31.0), or within 10 hexes of the hex the base would occupy when it is at Level 0; for example, a ship that undocks from a base at Temporal Elevation 4 could not target a Generator on a hex that was five hexes away. However, a unit within the Temporal Elevator may fire a Generator at a hex that is outside of the Elevator, similar to how a DisDev functions in an Elevator (G31.32), if the target hex is at least 10 hexes away from the hex where units enter the Elevator.

(G___.343) If a Generator is fired at a target hex that violates the limits of either (G___.341) or (G___.342), then the firing is automatically unsuccessful (G___.352). The energy in the Generator is lost, but the firing ship does not otherwise suffer; exception (G___.311).

(G___.344) The target hex may not be within 10 hexes of the target hex of another Generator fired from a different Generator-equipped unit, if the singularity has not yet formed. Once the singularity forms (G___.41), however, the target hex restriction, imposed by this rule and associated with that specific generated singularity, ends, and the (G___.341) restriction is used.

(G___.3441) The (G___.344) limit on the target hex cannot be overcome by the delay between firing the Generator and formation of the singularity, or by firing two Generators (on different units) at the same time.

(G___.3442) If two Generator-equipped units each fire at a target hex that violates the (G___.344) restriction, the second unit to fire its Generator (or both Generator-equipped units if they fired on the same impulse) is immediately drawn into a spatial rift and destroyed (without affecting anything else on the map); no singularity is formed by a unit destroyed under this rule.

(G___.345) Like a DisDev, a Singularity Generator has a 360-degree firing arc.

(G___.35) PROCEDURE: The Singularity Generator automatically "hits" the target hex, unless the firing unit is affected by a natural or other EW effect that produces a shift for all direct-fire targets. In general, an EW shift could only occur as the result of Offensive EW (G24.219) applied against the unit firing the Generator (including if the ship is using Erratic Maneuvering (C10.0)); or, as the result of terrain such as planetary atmosphere (P2.51), asteroids (P3.33), nebulae (P6.2), sunspots (P11.3), dust clouds (P13.4) or, ironically, a Black Hole (P4.23). In the case of a planetary atmosphere, a Black Hole or asteroids, while the Generator's target hex cannot be within 10 hexes of a planet, a Black Hole, or in an asteroid field, the direct path between the Generator's ship and the target hex could pass close enough to be affected by (P2.51), (P4.24) and/or (P3.33).

(G___.351) If the ship firing the Generator is affected by an EW shift, then use (D6.372) to determine if the Generator fires successfully.

(G___.352) In the event that a Generator doesn't fire successfully, the energy used to arm it is lost and it must be re-armed; in this situation, reserve warp energy may be used to begin the arming cycle (G___.211). There is no other effect (the firing ship is not damaged, the Generator is not destroyed, no distortion of space-time occurs); exception (G___.311). An unsuccessful attempt to operate the Singularity Generator does not count as operating a Generator for the purposes of (G___.32), (G___.344) or (G___.5).

(G ___.4) EFFECTS

(G___.41) FORMATION DELAYED: ¼ of a turn (eight impulses) after the Generator is successfully fired, a Black Hole (P4.0) forms in the target hex.

(G___.411) Prior to its formation, the incipient Black Hole has no effect. Since (G___.331) requires announcement of the target hex, an upside-down counter should be placed there when the Generator is fired. Even if the Andromedans were not required to announce the firing (G___.3311), an upside-down counter must still be placed in the target hex, as everyone with sensors will know that *something* unusual is happening there.

(G___.412) When the Black Hole forms, it does so at the end of the DIRECT-FIRE WEAPONS FIRE STAGE (6D2), and thus does not affect direct-fire weapons that impulse, and does not cause involuntary movement earlier in the impulse.

(G___.42) SINGULARITY EFFECTS: Once the Black Hole forms, it affects everything on the map as would a naturally-occurring (P4.1) (P4.2) Black Hole. No unit, including the Andromedan ship that generated the singularity, is immune (unless specifically noted as such in other rules).

(G___.421) If a unit is in the same hex as the Black Hole when it forms during the DIRECT-FIRE WEAPONS FIRE STAGE (6D2), then the unit is not destroyed until the INVOLUNTARY MOVEMENT STAGE (6A1) of the next impulse. This is a largely academic distinction that will be lost on any crew of such a unit.

(G___.422) The destruction of a ship in the Black Hole causes an immediate radiation burst (P4.21).

(G___.43) DURATION LIMITED: ½ of a turn (16 impulses) after it forms, the Black Hole collapses; this occurs at the end of the DIRECT-FIRE WEAPONS FIRE STAGE (6D2) of the impulse, so the Black Hole may cause involuntary movement on the impulse of its collapse, and also potentially affects direct-fire weapons that impulse.

(G___.44) GRAVITY WAVE FORMED: At the same instant it collapses, the Black Hole forms a Force 27 spherical Gravity Wave (P9.4), centered

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on the hex previously occupied by the Black Hole.
(G___.441) Since the Gravity Wave is formed after movement, it does not advance (P9.2) until the next impulse.
(G___.442) The Gravity Wave formed by the singularity decreases in strength as shown in (P9.42).

(G ___.5) MULTIPLE GENERATORS

Similar to a Displacement Device, a Singularity Generator has destabilizing effects on the very fabric of space-time. There is no record of more than one Singularity Generator being operated in an area at a time, and Galactic scientists who have studied the very few records of this technology agree that operating more than two Generators in close proximity would be extremely dangerous, at best.
(G___.51) PROXIMITY: For the purposes of multiple-Generator effects, any Generator operated within 10,000 tactical hexes of another Generator, within 10 turns, is affected by (G___.52).
(G___.52) OPERATION RESTRICTIONS: If more than two Generator-equipped units operate their Generators while in close proximity, then all ships attempting to operate their Generators are immediately drawn into a spatial rift and destroyed (without affecting anything else on the map) at the instant the third ship operates its Generator. No singularity is formed by any affected ship firing its Generator the impulse of its destruction (by the same token, a singularity formed or forming as a result of a Generator successfully fired on a previous impulse by a now-destroyed ship is not affected by the subsequent destruction).
(G___.521) If three Generator-equipped ships were in close proximity, and two had operated their Generators, then if one of those two was destroyed (by any means) or sucessfully disengaged by any means other than sublight evasion, the third ship could safely operate its Generator if it waited at least 10 tactical turns after the destroyed/disengaged ship had last operated its Generator.
(G___.522) The operation restrictions on DisDevs are separate from those on Singularity Generators, aside from the limitations imposed by (G___.32).

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